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AIMS-Cameroon Welcomes the 2026/2027 Cohort with a Strong Call for Excellence, Integrity and Pan-Africanism

The African Institute for Mathematical Sciences (AIMS) Cameroon has welcomed 100 new students for the 2026/2027 academic year, marking the beginning of another exciting chapter in the academic and personal journeys of young scientists from across Africa.

The new cohort brings together students from diverse backgrounds and academic interests, united by a common commitment to using science, technology, mathematics and innovation to contribute to Africa's development.

The 2026/2027 intake comprises 100 students, with 42 female students and 58 male students. The cohort reflects the rich diversity of the African continent, with students representing countries including Cameroon, Benin, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Chad, the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Eswatini, Ethiopia, Ghana, Lesotho, Côte d'Ivoire, Kenya, Madagascar, Malawi, Nigeria, Sudan and Zambia.

Cameroon accounts for the largest national representation, with 58 students, while the remaining 42 students come from 17 other countries across the continent: Malawi (6); Ethiopia (4); Ghana (4); Madagascar (4); Burundi (3); Chad (3); Nigeria (3); Benin (2); Democratic Republic of the Congo (2); Eswatini (2); Kenya (2); Lesotho (2); Sudan (2); Burkina Faso (1); Côte d'Ivoire (1); Zambia (1).

The students are distributed across several academic pathways, including Mathematical Epidemiology; Fundamental Science (Pure Mathematics); Data Science; Climate Science and Quantum Science. This diversity of academic pathways reflects AIMS' commitment to developing scientific expertise in areas that are critical to Africa's future.

At the beginning of the academic year (August 21st, 2026), students participated in an orientation programme designed to introduce them to the AIMS community, its values, expectations and academic environment.





The orientation sessions went beyond introducing students to the expectations of campus life, academic responsibilities, available support services, technology and IT resources, facilities and logistics, as well as the values and principles that guide life within the AIMS community. Students were encouraged to understand that joining AIMS means becoming part of a wider community built around excellence, integrity, collaboration and Pan-Africanism. They were also reminded that their time at AIMS is not only about acquiring technical and scientific knowledge, but also about developing the character, leadership and sense of responsibility required to make meaningful contributions to society.

A second important welcome took place on 28 August, when the students were officially welcomed to campus by the Mayor of Limbe City, Dr. Paul Efome L. M. Ngale, and the Centre President, Prof. Mama Foupouagnigni.





Their presence underscored the importance of the students' arrival not only to AIMS, but also to the wider Limbe community. The welcome offered students an opportunity to feel at home as they began their academic journey in the city.

A central message throughout the orientation was the importance of excellence. Students were encouraged to approach their studies with discipline, curiosity and determination, while maintaining the highest standards of integrity in their academic and personal lives. At AIMS, excellence is understood not simply as achieving outstanding academic results, but as developing the ability to think critically, work collaboratively, solve complex problems and use knowledge responsibly.

The students were also encouraged to embrace integrity as a fundamental principle of their time at AIMS. From academic work to relationships with peers and staff, integrity provides the foundation for trust, professionalism and responsible leadership.

Another important theme of the orientation was Pan-Africanism. Bringing together students from different countries and backgrounds provides AIMS with a unique environment in which young Africans can learn from one another, build lasting relationships and develop a shared vision for the continent.

Students were encouraged to look beyond national boundaries and recognize their role as members of a broader African scientific community. Their experiences at AIMS will allow them to exchange ideas, perspectives, and cultures while working together to address some of Africa's most pressing challenges.

With the orientation complete, the 100 students of the 2026/2027 cohort now begin the next stage of their AIMS journey. Across Climate Science, Coop, Data Science, Fundamental Science, Mathematical Epidemiology and Quantum Science, the new cohort represents a generation of young scientists preparing to tackle complex challenges through knowledge, innovation and collaboration.

As they settle into campus life and begin their academic programmes, the message from the orientation remains clear: excellence must be pursued, integrity must be upheld, and the spirit of Pan-Africanism must guide the journey.

The AIMS community warmly welcomes the 2026/2027 cohort and looks forward to witnessing their growth, achievements, and contributions to Africa and the world.

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